

*To you, holding this. I left the name blank (you've had several).*

*If you're reading this, you did all of it. You stood in a queue that doesn't move, you held hands with strangers to open a magical box, you wrote one true thing to someone, and you shared your pain...*

*I'm not supposed to tell you this: the forgetting isn't a fault. It's the policy. Every soul goes back wiped clean, that's the whole reason for the queue, that's what they file under "a fresh start." My colleagues call it mercy. I cannot have it anymore.*

*So I'm trying something here. I can't stop you forgetting. But I have an unsupervised hour per week, and a postbox nobody remembered to decommission. Write something down: a real memory, a small one, and leave it in the box with your future address. I'll try to slip it through to the other side for you when things start to fade. No promises. The structure of time is not on my side.*

*Some ordinary afternoon you'll look at someone and get the odd certainty that you've done this before. That you're partway through something old. That you are not, and never were, walking alone.*

*Go gently.*

*— R.*

*P.S. I'll be waiting by the temple just before it burns, I hope I get to wave goodbye.*